

field, type the IP address as the machine name and the shared resource as a UNC.

Enabling auto complete

Q I use Windows 98 and IE to browse the Net. I shut off the auto complete feature by mistake and would like to enable it again.

A In order to enable the auto complete feature in Internet Explorer, go to **Tools > Internet Options > Content**. Here, click on the Auto Complete button and enable the options. You will also be prompted to key in user name and password.

HARD DISKS

Hard disk capacity shows less

Q I have recently purchased a 15.3 GB hard disk but my system does not display it as 15.3 GB. Has my dealer cheated me?

A No, your dealer has not cheated you. But your system is not lying either because 1 GB is equivalent to 1024 MB (raw, unformatted). Also, when you format your hard disk and install your operating system, the file allocation that is done is such that it always puts some blank space before placing data for another file. As a result, the blank space is considered as having been utilised and hence, the actual size of a hard disk would always be lesser after you've formatted it.

Setting multiple primary partitions

Q I want to have multiple primary partitions, one per operating system. Is there is any utility which will ask me which OS to use at boot time?

A You can do this with a utility called Boot Manager. This utility inserts itself into the beginning of the boot process, sets up a special boot manager partition and then makes itself the active partition. When you boot up the PC, the code in this partition runs. It analyses the primary partitions on the disk and then presents a menu and asks which operating system you want to use. It marks the one you select as active, and then continues the boot process from there.

System Commander 7 and BootIt Direct are some other boot managers that can handle this task efficiently.

BIOS shows less hard disk capacity

Q The BIOS detects the hard disk drive

There are plenty of tools that can check and ensure that your PC gives you trouble-free performance. For example, Norton System Works

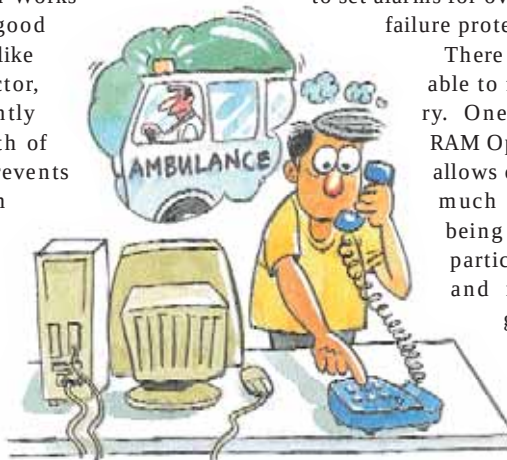
2002 provides good diagnostic utilities like Norton Disk Doctor, which constantly monitors the health of your hard disk, prevents deletion of system files and fixes registry errors, and has a special disk defragmenting utility to speed up your machine.

Tools like motherboard

Getting Help

monitor (mbm.livewiredev.com) display your motherboard temperature and the internal fan speeds, and even allow you to set alarms for overheat and fan failure protection.

There are tools available to free up memory. One such tool is RAM Optimizer which allows one to see how much memory is being occupied by a particular program, and root out programs that are no longer being used but still occupy RAM.



but does not recognise the actual capacity. Why is it so?

A It's quite frustrating to find that not all of your hard disk is actually accessible, especially when you are trying to add a new hard disk to an older system. This is almost always due to the BIOS not properly recognising the hard disk structures and access routines. This problem can be rectified by upgrading the BIOS or by using third-party disk managers. In some cases, these problems are due to actual hardware or software bugs that are not detected until hard disks grow in size beyond a certain point.

Check documentation to see if your motherboard supports LBA mode. This allows recognition of hard drive sizes

the drive. Driver procedures vary, but generally the driver will load before DOS or Windows, enabling the system to see more than a 528 MB drive. The same goes for systems in which the BIOS recognises a maximum of 8.4 GB even in LBA mode.

Damned by DMA

Q After enabling the DMA for my hard disk drive, I can't boot Windows in the normal mode, get too many errors, and also cannot uncheck the DMA option in the safe mode. How do I uncheck the DMA option?

A Booting into safe mode is usually the fail-safe method for changing settings back to the default. If you cannot deselect the option in safe mode, go to the page

The BIOS on older motherboards have problems detecting high capacity drives

greater than 528 MB. If LBA mode is not supported, the system will only recognise a maximum 528 MB, regardless of how large the hard drive is.

Non-LBA systems require a driver to be loaded to overcome the 528 MB barrier. Most large hard drives come with a driver disk and instructions for loading it, or have the driver already installed on

in the CMOS Setup that sets the operating parameters for your hard drive and temporarily disable the DMA mode. Run Windows in Normal mode and everything will operate normally, although disk performance will be reduced.

After starting Windows in the Normal mode, deselect the DMA option that you had enabled initially.